

The Vale Federation Date: 28/02/2022

Report: Onsite Visit and Remote Consultation

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Consultation details

An initial onsite visit was conducted by Data Protection Education in February 2022. All three sites were visited, Booker Park, Stocklake Park and Harding House. This visit focused on identifying physical risks present in the schools.

A remote consultation was scheduled following the onsite visit. The Trust was introduced to the available tools on our platform, the Knowledge Bank.

Visible Risks

Booker Park School

Risk 1

Location- Staffroom

Risk- Personal Information Accessible

Severity- Medium-High

Staff pigeonholes contained medical information and other personal data. These can be viewed by anyone which presents a risk to the information through unlawful access.

Recommendations-

1. Remove the personal information from pigeonholes
2. Remind all staff that no personal information should be placed or stored in pigeonholes
3. Encourage the use of digital and electronic systems where available

Risk 2

Location- General

Risk- Personal Information Accessible

Severity- Low-Medium

Pupil personal information visible on wall displays in classrooms. These displays are acceptable when the data is kept to a minimum and complies with an educational aim

Recommendation-

1. Encourage all staff to review what personal data is displayed on a wall. Consider whether it achieves an educational aim. If not, it should be removed

Risk 3

Location- Classroom

Risk- Unlocked Computer

Severity- Medium

The computer was unlocked with Arbour and all other files accessible. Cupboards were also unlocked as was the door. This presents a risk as anyone who has been granted access to the school, can access this information. There will be a variety of people allowed access to the school but not to see the data the computer and cupboards contained.

Recommendations-

1. All staff should be reminded to lock their computers when leaving them
2. Remove automatic logins for appropriate apps so they cannot be accessed if someone has accessed the main computer
3. Implement a short lock out time where possible
4. Remind all staff to lock the door when leaving a classroom unattended

Harding House

Risk 1

Location- Reception

Risk- Personal Data on Display

Severity- Low

Visitor sign-in is currently done on paper. This can then be seen by anyone who signs in which should not be shared.

Recommendation-

1. If an electronic sign-in system is not viable due to limited use and finances, use a carbon copy book where the written information cannot be seen on the front page

DPE Knowledge Bank

A meeting was held to introduce the Trust to the tools available on the Knowledge Bank. Please see an overview of the tools available:

SAR and Breach Logs-

The only individuals authorised to make and view these logs are those who are School Managers on the Knowledge Bank.

All subject access request should be logged using the tools available.

All breach incidents should be logged and a member of the team will respond to let you know the correct course of action, including whether a report to the ICO is necessary, which we would make on your behalf.

Best Practice Library and Checklists-

There is a best practice library now available of the Knowledge Bank that cover various different scenarios that schools face on a daily basis. This library is continuing to grow but contains the appropriate support for that particular query. For example this may be a policy, policy statement, guidance, external documentation etc.

Associated to each best practice area is a checklist that, once completed, helps the school demonstrate compliance in a visual, simple but effective manner.

Please begin to work on these checklists as they will be discussed in future meetings.

Document Management Tool-

You are now able to upload documents, assign them to staff to be read and receive a record that they have been viewed, signed by staff or that consent has been obtained.

These documents could be a staff privacy policy, our audit report or any document the schools needs to communicate to staff members.

Next Steps

- Review and implement the recommendations made from the walkaround
- Review the information contained within the Knowledge Bank to make best use of the tools
- Introduce other key members of staff to the Knowledge Bank as appropriate
- Ensure all breaches and SARs are logged on the Knowledge Bank to maintain compliance